ABC Private Limited

People and Culture (Human Resources) | Kolkata - Bengaluru - Pune - Hyderabad

Human Resources Policy Manual

From recruitment to retirement: every people policy of ABC Private Limited

Field	Details
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Approved by	Board Human Resources Committee
Applicability	All employees of ABC Private Limited in India: permanent, probationary, fixed-term and interns. Contractors are covered only by Sections 12, 14 and 15.
HR helpdesk	hr-helpdesk@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4100 | Mon-Fri 09:00-18:00 IST

Disclaimer: ABC Private Limited is a fictional company. All names, figures, policies and contact details are invented for demonstration and testing (for example as a sample knowledge base for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation project).

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How to read this manual: every policy states its purpose, who it applies to, the rule, the timelines and the approving authority. Where a rule says "HRBP" it means the Human Resources Business Partner assigned to the employee's department. "PeopleHub" is ABC's HRMS portal. Grades run from G1 (trainee) to G9 (senior leadership).

1. HR Philosophy, Scope and Governance

The HR function at ABC exists to attract capable people, treat them fairly, help them grow and manage the employment relationship lawfully. This manual consolidates all people policies. It applies to every employee from the date of joining until the last working day. Where this manual is silent, the Company's Code of Conduct and applicable Indian law apply. Where a law is more beneficial to the employee than this manual, the law prevails.

1.1 Guiding Principles

- **Fairness:** decisions on hiring, pay, promotion and discipline are based on merit, documented facts and consistent criteria.
- **Transparency:** employees can see their leave balance, payslip, goals, ratings and policy documents on PeopleHub at any time.
- **Confidentiality:** personal and medical information is shared only with those who need it, and is protected under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.
- **Compliance:** ABC follows the Shops and Establishments Acts of the states where it operates, the Code on Wages, the Code on Social Security, the Industrial Relations Code, the Maternity Benefit Act, the POSH Act, the Payment of Gratuity Act and the Employees' Provident Fund Act.

1.2 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Know and follow policies; keep personal data, bank and nominee details updated; apply for leave and regularise attendance on time
Reporting Manager	Set goals, approve leave and attendance, give regular feedback, conduct reviews, first-level grievance handling, ensure fair treatment
HR Business Partner (HRBP)	Interpret policy, advise on employee relations, support performance and discipline, run the department's HR calendar
HR Operations and Payroll	Onboarding records, attendance and leave administration, payroll, statutory filings, F and F settlement
Compensation and Benefits	Salary bands, benchmarking, increments, insurance and benefit schemes
Talent Acquisition	Sourcing, interviews, offers, campus hiring, background verification coordination
CHRO	Policy owner; final internal appeal on HR matters; exceptions for G6 and above

1.3 Policy Changes and Exceptions

The CHRO may amend any policy with 15 days' notice to employees through PeopleHub and e-mail. Changes that reduce an existing benefit apply only prospectively. Exceptions to a policy must be requested in writing by the Department Head, reviewed by the HRBP and approved by the CHRO, and are recorded in the Exceptions Register. An exception for one employee does not set a precedent for another.

2. Recruitment and Selection Policy

2.1 Manpower Planning and Requisition

- Headcount for the next financial year is approved in February by the CFO, COO and CHRO.
- A Job Requisition (JR) is raised on PeopleHub with title, grade, skills, location, budget band and reason (new or replacement). Approval chain: Department Head, Finance Business Partner, HRBP. G7 and above also need CHRO and CEO approval.
- A JR is valid for 90 days and must be re-validated if still open. Hiring without an approved JR, or giving verbal offers, is not permitted.

2.2 Sourcing and Internal Job Posting

Preference order for sourcing: internal postings, employee referrals, campus hiring, careers page and professional networks, empanelled agencies, walk-in drives. Every opening up to G6 is posted internally for 7 calendar days. An employee may apply if they have 12 months in the current role, a rating of 3 or above, no active PIP and no disciplinary action in the last 12 months. The current manager is informed after shortlisting, and release must happen within 60 days. Agency fees are capped at 8.33% of annual fixed CTC for G5-G6 and 12% for G7 and above, payable after the candidate completes 90 days.

2.3 Employee Referral Scheme

Grade of hire	Bonus (INR)	Conditions
G1 - G3	25,000	Paid with salary after the referred employee completes 90 days
G4 - G5	50,000	Same
G6 and above	1,00,000	CHRO approval required
Niche skills (Gen AI, cybersecurity architect, SAP S/4HANA)	Additional 15,000	On top of the grade-based amount

HR and Talent Acquisition staff, the hiring manager and interview panel members cannot claim referral bonus for that role. Both the referrer and the referred employee must be in service on the payout date.

2.4 Selection Process and Interview Conduct

Stage	Details	Timeline
Resume screening	Match against JR criteria	3 working days
Online assessment	Aptitude, coding or domain test, 60-90 minutes, cut-off 60%	5 working days
Technical rounds	One round for G1-G2; two rounds from G3 (second covers design or case study)	7 working days
Managerial round	Role fit, ownership, stakeholder handling	3 working days
HR round	Values, motivation, compensation, notice period	2 working days
Leadership round	Mandatory for G6 and above	5 working days

Interviewers submit written feedback on PeopleHub within 24 hours using a 5-point scale. A hire requires "Hire" or "Strong Hire" from every technical and managerial interviewer. Interviewers must declare any relationship with the candidate and withdraw from the panel. Questions on marital status, family plans, religion, caste or health are not allowed. Target time-to-offer is 30 days for G1-G4 and 45 days for G5 and above.

2.5 Eligibility, Offer and Joining Rules

- **Freshers:** B.E./B.Tech/M.Tech/MCA/M.Sc in CS or IT with at least 60% or CGPA 6.5, and no active backlog at joining.
- **Offer validity:** 10 calendar days. Maximum gap between acceptance and joining is 60 days (90 days for G6 and above). Extension needs HRBP approval.
- **Joining bonus:** only for G4 and above, up to 15% of fixed CTC, paid in the first payroll. If the employee resigns within 12 months, 100% is recovered; between 12 and 18 months, 50%.
- **Relocation:** lump-sum INR 40,000 within India (INR 1,00,000 for G6 and above) plus 15 days of temporary accommodation.
- **Dual employment** is not allowed; candidates must disclose any ongoing employment or freelance work.

2.6 Background Verification

Every offer is conditional on a satisfactory background check by an external agency, completed within 21 working days of joining. It covers education, last two employers, address and criminal record; for G6 and above it also covers a credit and directorship check. A discrepancy that amounts to misrepresentation (forged documents, hidden employment, false experience) can lead to termination without notice or compensation. Minor, explained discrepancies are reviewed by the HRBP.

3. Onboarding, Induction and Probation

3.1 Joining Formalities

On the first day the employee completes a joining form on PeopleHub, signs the offer letter, the Code of Conduct, the confidentiality and intellectual property agreement and the information security acknowledgement, and submits the following documents: government photo ID (Aadhaar), PAN, passport-size photographs, educational certificates, relieving letter and last three payslips from previous employers, address proof, bank details, UAN (if any) and a nominee declaration for PF, gratuity and insurance. Joining formalities must be complete within 7 working days. IT assets (laptop, access card, e-mail, VPN) are issued on day one.

3.2 Induction Programme

Period	Activity	Owner
Day 1	Welcome, office tour, policy walkthrough, IT set-up, buddy assigned	HR Operations and Admin
Week 1	Company orientation, values (C.R.A.F.T.), information security and POSH e-learning	HR and L and D
Weeks 2-8	Role-specific training; for graduate trainees the 8-week ABC Launchpad academy	Department and L and D
Day 30	First check-in with manager and HRBP; goals finalised	Manager
Day 90	Buddy programme ends; 90-day feedback conversation	Manager and HRBP

3.3 Probation and Confirmation

- Probation is 6 months for G1-G5 and 3 months for G6 and above. It can be extended once, by up to 3 months, with written reasons.
- The manager evaluates the employee at 30, 90 and 150 days (for 6-month probation). Confirmation needs a satisfactory manager and HRBP assessment and completion of mandatory training and background verification.
- A confirmation letter is issued within 15 days of approval. Silence does not mean confirmation: the employee remains on probation until the written letter is issued.
- Notice period during probation is 15 days from either side (30 days for G6 and above).
- During probation, an employee earns Privilege Leave but can avail it only after confirmation, except in a medical emergency approved by the HRBP.

4. Employee Categories, Grades and Transfers

Category	Definition and key rules
Permanent	Confirmed full-time employee; full benefits
Probationer	Not yet confirmed; eligible for all benefits except first-cycle performance bonus
Fixed-term	Hired for 6-24 months for a project; statutory benefits, medical insurance and PL; no ESOP
Intern	2-6 months; stipend INR 15,000-25,000 per month; 1 day leave per month
Contractor/Consultant	Not an employee; governed by service contract

Grade	Typical designations	Experience (years)	Notice period
G1-G2	Graduate Engineer Trainee, Associate Engineer / Executive	0-3	30 days
G3	Engineer, Senior Executive, Analyst	3-5	30 days
G4-G5	Senior Engineer, Assistant Manager, Technical Lead, Manager	5-12	60 days
G6-G7	Senior Manager, Architect, Associate Director	12-18	90 days
G8-G9	Director, Vice President, SVP and above	18+	90 days

4.1 Transfers, Relocation and Secondments

- **Internal transfer:** between departments through IJP or by management need, with no loss of grade or fixed pay. Effective date is agreed within 60 days.
- **Location transfer:** 30 days' notice; relocation benefit as in 2.5; employees with documented medical or caregiving constraints may request deferral of up to 3 months.
- **Client-site deployment:** follows the client's working calendar; the employee remains on ABC's policies for leave, pay and conduct.
- **Acting and additional charge:** an employee holding a higher role for more than 90 days receives an acting allowance of 10% of basic pay.

5. Working Hours, Attendance and Hybrid Work

- **Week and hours:** Monday-Friday, 9 hours a day including a 1-hour break (45 hours a week); standard shift 09:30-18:30 IST. Core collaboration hours are 11:00-16:00. Maximum 12 hours a day and 60 hours a week in any case.
- **Shifts:** evening shift allowance INR 150 per day, night shift INR 350 per day; free cab between 20:00 and 07:00. On-call engineers get INR 1,500 per week.
- **Hybrid model (3-2 Flex):** office on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday; WFH on Monday and Friday with manager approval. New joiners (first 90 days) and trainees work from office five days. Work From Anywhere within India is limited to 20 days per financial year with HRBP and security approval. Internet and utility reimbursement: INR 1,000 per month if WFH exceeds 6 days a month.
- **Recording attendance:** biometric or RFID in office, PeopleHub clock-in for WFH. Minimum 8 hours for a full day; under 4.5 hours is absent.
- **Late marks:** 15 minutes' grace, up to 3 times a month. The fourth and later late arrivals deduct half-day Casual Leave, or LOP if none is left.
- **Regularisation:** missed punches must be corrected within 3 working days; payroll cut-off is the 22nd of the month.
- **Absconding:** unauthorised absence beyond 3 consecutive working days triggers notices to the registered address and e-mail; with no response within 7 days, employment stands terminated.
- **Overtime:** G1-G2 (non-exempt) get double the hourly wage for work beyond 9 hours, capped at 50 overtime hours per quarter. G3 and above are exempt; if they work 6 hours or more on a weekly off or holiday they earn one Comp-Off, valid for 60 days, not encashable.

5.1 Holidays

ABC gives 12 fixed public holidays and 2 floating holidays per calendar year. The calendar is published by Admin by 15 December. Floating holidays must be applied for 7 days in advance. A holiday that falls on a weekend is not substituted. Regional offices may swap Bengal-specific holidays for local ones, keeping the total at 12.

6. Leave Policy

The leave year is 1 January to 31 December. Entitlements are pro-rated by completed months for joiners and leavers (joining on or before the 15th counts as a full month). Leave is applied for on PeopleHub and approved by the manager. For unplanned leave, inform the manager before 10:00 on the day and apply within 2 working days.

Leave type	Entitlement per year	Carry forward	Encashment	Key conditions
Casual Leave	8 days	No	No	Maximum 3 consecutive days
Sick Leave	10 days	No	No	Medical certificate for 3+ consecutive days; fitness certificate after 5+ days
Privilege Leave	18 days (1.5 per month)	Up to 36 days	At exit, up to 36 days (basic/26 per day)	Minimum 3 days per planned application; apply 7 days ahead if over 5 days
Maternity	26 weeks (first two children); 12 weeks thereafter	N/A	N/A	At least 80 days worked in preceding 12 months
Paternity	10 working days	No	No	Within 6 months of birth
Adoption	12 weeks	N/A	N/A	Primary adopting parent, child under 3 months
Marriage	5 working days, once	No	No	Invitation card or registration proof
Bereavement	5 working days per event (plus 3 for travel over 500 km)	No	No	Spouse, child, parent, sibling or parent-in-law
Wellness Days	2 days	No	No	No reason needed; apply 1 day ahead
Volunteer Day	1 day	No	No	For ABC Sparsha CSR activity

6.1 Detailed Leave Rules

- **Maternity:** up to 8 weeks may be taken before delivery. Miscarriage or medical termination: 6 weeks; tubectomy: 2 weeks; illness from pregnancy or delivery: 1 month. After maternity leave, up to 3 months of WFH may be requested. Creche reimbursement: INR 6,000 per month for children up to 4 years. The Navya programme supports women returning after a career break of 6 months to 5 years.
- **Sandwich rule:** if an employee takes unplanned leave on the working days both before and after a weekly off or holiday, the intervening off or holiday is counted as leave.
- **Notice period:** PL cannot be taken during notice without HRBP approval; leave taken extends the last working day day-for-day, except medical emergencies.
- **Loss of Pay:** absence not covered by leave is deducted at monthly gross divided by calendar days. Leave without pay up to 30 days a year needs Department Head and HRBP approval; beyond 30 days it affects increment and PL accrual.
- **Sabbatical:** G4 and above with 7+ years' service may take 1 to 3 months' unpaid sabbatical once in their career; group medical cover continues.
- **Leave balances** should be checked monthly; discrepancies must be raised with HR Operations within 15 days. Leave cannot be encashed on resignation except PL up to 36 days.

7. Compensation and Payroll Policy

7.1 Salary Structure

Component	Rule
Basic salary	40% of fixed CTC; base for PF, gratuity and encashment
House Rent Allowance	50% of basic in Kolkata, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Chennai; 40% elsewhere
Special allowance	Balancing component; fully taxable
Employer PF	12% of basic (or on the INR 15,000 wage ceiling, as opted)
Gratuity	4.81% of basic, part of CTC
Meal and wellness card	INR 2,200 per month, optional
Variable pay	Annual, paid in June, as per Section 7.2

7.2 Variable Pay and Increments

Grade	Target variable (% of fixed CTC)	Weight: company / individual
G1-G2	5%	50 / 50
G3-G4	8-10%	40 / 60
G5-G6	12-15%	40 / 60
G7-G8	20-25%	50 / 50
G9	30% and above	As set by Board HR Committee

Rating	Meaning	Increment range	Bonus multiplier
5	Outstanding	12-18%	up to 1.5x
4	Exceeds Expectations	8-12%	1.25x
3	Meets Expectations	5-8%	1.0x
2	Partially Meets	0-3%	0.6x
1	Needs Improvement	0%	0

Increments are effective 1 April and communicated by 30 April. Joiners after 1 October are considered in the next cycle. Variable payout is multiplied by a company performance factor of 0.5 to 1.25. Employees who resign or are terminated before the payout date forfeit the bonus.

7.3 Payroll Rules

- Salary is credited on the last working day of the month; payslips are on PeopleHub by the 3rd of the next month.
- Deductions: employee PF 12% of basic, Professional Tax as per state law, TDS under the Income Tax Act, Labour Welfare Fund where applicable.
- Tax declarations: estimates in April, proofs in December. Late or wrong proofs can raise TDS in the last quarter.
- Overpayments are recovered in up to 3 instalments with written intimation to the employee.

- Reimbursement claims must be filed within 30 days with receipts and are settled within 10 working days of approval.
- Individual salary details are confidential; employees must not use pay information of others to create disruption.

7.4 Benefits

Benefit	Coverage and rules
Group Mediclaim	INR 5,00,000 family floater (self, spouse, up to 2 children), premium paid by ABC; maternity cover INR 75,000 normal / INR 1,00,000 caesarean; cashless at 4,500+ hospitals; pre-existing conditions covered from day one
Parents' cover	Optional INR 3,00,000 at group rates, deducted from salary
Group Term Life	3x annual fixed CTC, minimum INR 15 lakh
Personal Accident	INR 10,00,000 for accidental death or permanent total disability
Health check-up	Annual, free; twice a year from age 40
Employee Assistance Programme	24x7 counselling, 8 free sessions per year per person, includes family
Gym and sports	INR 6,000 per year on invoices
ESOP 2022	G5 and above and top performers with 2+ years of service; 4-year vesting 10/20/30/40%
Long-service awards	INR 10,000 (5 years), INR 25,000 (10 years), INR 50,000 (15 years)
Gratuity	After 5 years of continuous service: last basic x 15/26 x completed years, maximum INR 20 lakh; no minimum service on death or disablement

8. Performance Management, Promotion and Recognition

Period	Activity
April	Goal setting (OKRs and competencies) within 30 days of cycle start
October	Mid-year check-in; goals can be revised for business change
January-February	Self-assessment, 3-5 peer reviewers, manager assessment
February-March	Calibration by Department Heads and HRBPs
March-April	Ratings communicated, feedback conversation, increment and promotion letters

Guided distribution: rating 5 about 5-10%, rating 4 about 20-25%, rating 3 about 50-55%, rating 2 about 10-15%, rating 1 below 5%. An employee who disagrees with a rating can appeal in writing to the HRBP within 10 working days; the Grievance Redressal Committee decides within 15 working days and its decision is final.

8.1 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

- Applies to ratings of 1 or 2, or sustained under-performance. Duration 60 to 90 days with measurable goals, a documented kick-off and fortnightly reviews.
- The employee may seek mentoring and training support. During a PIP there is no promotion, internal transfer or increment.
- Outcomes: successful closure, extension of up to 30 days, or separation with notice or pay in lieu.

8.2 Promotion

Promotions are effective 1 April (exceptional mid-year promotions effective 1 October). Eligibility: at least 18 months in grade (12 months for high-performing G1-G2), rating 4 or above in the last cycle or 3 in two consecutive cycles, demonstrated next-level competencies, and an available role and budget. Promotion increase is typically 8-15% of fixed pay, only one grade at a time. G6 and above need CHRO and CEO approval.

8.3 Recognition

- Spot Awards of INR 2,000 to 10,000 by managers; Star of the Quarter INR 25,000 per department; Founders' Award INR 1,00,000 annually.

9. Learning, Development and Career Growth

- Every employee must complete at least 40 learning hours a year on the ABC Academy portal (managers: 16 of these on leadership topics).
- Mandatory courses within 30 days of joining and every year: Code of Conduct, Information Security, POSH, Anti-Bribery and Data Privacy; pass mark 80%.
- Certification support up to INR 50,000 per year for job-relevant certifications, with a 12-month lock-in and proportionate recovery on early exit. A cash incentive of INR 5,000 is paid on clearing high-value certifications.
- Higher education sponsorship: G3 and above with 3+ years' service and rating 4 or above; 50% of tuition up to INR 2,00,000; 24-month service bond.
- Mentoring: a 90-day buddy and a first-year mentor for every new joiner; first-time manager programme Lead 1.0; senior leadership programme for G6 and above.
- Internal gigs: up to 20% of time on approved internal projects; job rotation possible after 24 months in a role.

10. Code of Conduct and Ethics

10.1 Standards of Behaviour

Employees must act honestly, protect Company and client interests, follow the law and treat all colleagues with respect. Smart casual dress is required daily; formal attire for clients. Traditional and religious attire is respected. Alcohol and illegal substances are prohibited on premises and at official events during working hours. ID cards must be worn on premises. Smoking is permitted only in designated zones.

10.2 Conflict of Interest, Gifts and Outside Work

- Declare any personal, financial or family interest that may conflict with ABC's business, every year and whenever it changes.
- Working for or running a competitor, client or vendor business while employed is prohibited. Teaching, writing, open-source or non-profit work needs prior written HRBP approval and must not use Company time, assets or information.
- Relatives must not be in a reporting or approval relationship. Close personal relationships between a manager and a report must be disclosed to HR, and the reporting line is changed.
- Gifts and hospitality: maximum INR 2,500 per occasion and INR 10,000 per year from one source, declared in the Gifts Register. Cash is never accepted. Bribery of any official is strictly prohibited.

10.3 Information, Confidentiality and Social Media

- Confidentiality continues for 3 years after exit (indefinitely for trade secrets and personal data). Work product created during employment belongs to ABC.
- Only approved AI tools may be used for work; client or personal data must never be entered into public AI tools.
- Personal views on social media must be clearly personal. Client names, financials and unreleased products must not be posted. Only authorised spokespersons speak to the media.

11. Prevention of Sexual Harassment, Equal Opportunity and Whistleblowing

11.1 POSH Policy

ABC prohibits sexual harassment as defined in the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013, including unwelcome physical contact, requests for sexual favours, sexually coloured remarks, showing pornography and any other unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature, whether in person, online or at off-site and client locations.

- The Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) has a woman Presiding Officer (senior leader), at least two employee members and one external member from an NGO or legal background.
- Complaint in writing to icc@abc-pvt.example or in person within 3 months of the incident (extendable by 3 months for good reason). Help in writing the complaint is provided.
- The ICC completes the inquiry within 90 days and submits its report within 10 days. The employer acts within 60 days. Conciliation is only at the complainant's request and never through a monetary settlement.
- Interim relief can include transfer, up to 3 months' leave or changed reporting. Identities are kept confidential; retaliation is major misconduct. False complaints made with malicious intent can attract action, but a complaint not

proven is not treated as malicious.

- Annual POSH training is mandatory for all employees; the ICC files an annual report with the district authority.

11.2 Equal Opportunity and Anti-Discrimination

Discrimination, bullying, victimisation and derogatory remarks based on gender, religion, caste, race, nationality, language, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, age or marital status are not tolerated. ABC targets 35% women in the workforce by March 2028, provides reasonable adjustments for employees with disabilities, and supports employee resource groups: Women@ABC, Pride@ABC and AbleTogether.

11.3 Whistleblower Policy

Concerns about fraud, bribery, financial misreporting, data theft, safety violations or serious Code breaches can be reported to the external Ethics Helpline (ethics@abc-pvt.example or 1800-000-0001, 24x7, anonymous reporting allowed). The Ethics and Whistleblower Committee, chaired by an independent director, acknowledges within 3 working days and typically completes the investigation within 60 days. Retaliation against a good-faith reporter is prohibited and leads to disciplinary action.

12. Disciplinary Policy and Grievance Redressal

Category	Examples	Typical action
Minor	Repeated late arrival, minor policy breach, unprofessional behaviour, mandatory training not completed	Verbal counselling or written warning
Major	Unauthorised absence for 3+ days, security policy violation, misuse of assets, insubordination, negligence, falsifying records	Final warning, suspension, withholding of increment or bonus, demotion
Gross	Fraud, theft, proven sexual harassment, violence, data leakage, bribery, document forgery, substance abuse at work, concealed conflict of interest	Termination for cause without notice or severance; legal action where applicable

12.1 Disciplinary Procedure

- **Step 1:** preliminary fact-finding by the HRBP and manager within 5 working days.
- **Step 2:** written show-cause notice; the employee has 3 working days to reply.
- **Step 3:** for major and gross misconduct, a domestic inquiry committee (HRBP, a senior manager from another department, Legal) holds a hearing; the employee may present evidence and bring a colleague.
- **Step 4:** written order within 30 days of inquiry start; appeal to the CHRO within 7 days.
- Suspension during inquiry carries a subsistence allowance of 50% of basic pay for the first 90 days. Warning records stay on file for 24 months.

12.2 Grievance Redressal

Level	Authority	Acknowledge within	Resolve within
1	Reporting Manager	1 working day	3 working days
2	HRBP	1 working day	5 working days
3	Grievance Redressal Committee	2 working days	10 working days
4	CHRO	2 working days	15 working days

The Grievance Redressal Committee comprises the CHRO's nominee, a Department Head from another department, a Legal representative and an employee representative elected every 2 years. Employees are protected from retaliation for raising a grievance.

13. Health, Safety and Employee Wellbeing

- Fire drills twice a year; floor wardens and first-aiders on every floor; a medical room at each office and a doctor on call. Accidents, injuries and near-misses must be reported to Admin and HR within 24 hours.
- Women working between 20:00 and 07:00 get a GPS-tracked cab with a guard; drivers are police-verified; women are dropped first and picked up last.
- Mental health: Employee Assistance Programme, mental-health first-aiders, quarterly wellbeing webinars and an annual Wellness Week. Managers are trained to spot burnout; employees may use Wellness Days without giving a reason.
- Employees returning after a long medical absence (over 5 days) need a fitness certificate. Reasonable adjustments are made for employees with disabilities or chronic conditions on request to the HRBP.
- In an epidemic or emergency, the Crisis Management Team may require work from home and symptom reporting as per government guidelines.
- Support for employees seeking rehabilitation for substance dependence is available through the EAP without penalty for voluntary disclosure.

14. Separation, Exit and Full and Final Settlement

14.1 Resignation and Notice

Grade	Confirmed employee	During probation
G1-G3	30 days	15 days
G4-G5	60 days	15 days
G6-G9	90 days	30 days

- Resignation is submitted in writing or on PeopleHub to the manager with a copy to the HRBP; the Company accepts or rejects it in writing within 7 working days. A resignation can be withdrawn within 7 days with the manager's consent.
- Notice buy-out: the employee may pay basic plus fixed allowances for unserved days; approval is at the Company's discretion and can be refused for critical projects or pending investigations. The Company may release an employee earlier and pay in lieu of notice, in which case the employee owes nothing.
- Before the last working day the employee must complete knowledge transfer, return all assets (laptop, access card, documents), clear dues and attend the exit interview.

14.2 Termination by the Company

The Company may terminate for (a) poor performance after an unsuccessful PIP, with notice or pay in lieu; (b) misconduct after the disciplinary procedure; (c) business reasons such as restructuring, with notice and severance of 15 days' basic pay for each completed year of service in addition to statutory compensation; (d) misrepresentation or failed background verification. Gross misconduct attracts termination without notice or severance. Absconding is dealt with under Section 5.

14.3 Full and Final Settlement and Documents

- F and F includes salary to the last working day, PL encashment (maximum 36 days), gratuity if eligible, bonus if eligible, less notice shortfall, advances, clawbacks and tax. It is paid within 45 days of the last working day after all clearances.
- Experience and relieving letters are issued within 7 working days of clearance; Form 16 is issued by 15 June.
- PF transfer or withdrawal is facilitated through the UAN. Gratuity may be forfeited, wholly or partly, only as the law allows, for gross misconduct causing damage or loss.
- **Retirement:** normal retirement age is 60, on the last day of the month the employee turns 60. Retirees receive gratuity, PL encashment, farewell recognition, access to self-paid group medical cover and may be engaged as consultants for up to 12 months.
- **Rehire:** former employees who left in good standing after serving notice may be rehired after a 6-month cooling-off; those terminated for misconduct or who absconded are ineligible. Past service is counted only if the break is under 90 days and the CHRO approves.
- **Exit interview** is held in the last week of notice; findings are used anonymously. The ABC Alumni network gives priority in rehire and access to webinars.

15. HR Records, Data Privacy and Compliance

Record	Retention period
Personnel file (offer, contract, KYC, appraisals)	8 years after separation
Attendance and leave records	8 years
Payroll, PF, ESI, gratuity and tax records	8 years (or as law requires, whichever is longer)
Disciplinary and inquiry records	8 years; warnings are inactive after 24 months
POSH complaint and inquiry files	As per POSH Act and Rules; minimum 8 years
Unsuccessful candidate data	12 months, then deleted
Medical records held by HR	5 years after separation; restricted access

- Employee data is used only for employment purposes, shared with third parties (insurers, payroll vendor, background-check agency) under contract, and protected by role-based access. Employees may view and correct their data on PeopleHub and may request details of how it is used from the Data Protection Officer.
- Statutory compliance calendar: PF and ESI monthly by the 15th, Professional Tax monthly or yearly as per state, TDS monthly by the 7th, Form 24Q quarterly, gratuity trust contribution annually, POSH annual report by 31 January, Shops and Establishments registers and returns as per state rules.
- ABC does not employ anyone under 18 years, does not use forced labour, respects the right of association and pays at least the minimum wage and equal pay for equal work irrespective of gender.

16. Quick Reference and Contacts

Question	Answer
Notice period for G6?	90 days (30 days in probation)
PL carry forward limit?	36 days; excess lapses on 31 December
Late marks allowed per month?	3 (15-minute grace); from the 4th, half-day CL or LOP
Probation period?	6 months for G1-G5, 3 months for G6 and above; extendable once by 3 months
Maternity leave?	26 weeks (first two children), 12 weeks from the third; paternity 10 working days
Joining bonus clawback?	100% within 12 months, 50% between 12 and 18 months
F and F timeline?	Within 45 days of last working day
POSH complaint deadline?	3 months from incident; inquiry completed in 90 days
Increment effective date?	1 April every year
Retirement age?	60 years

Need	Contact
General HR	hr-helpdesk@abc-pvt.example, Ext. 4100
Payroll	payroll@abc-pvt.example, Ext. 4120
Recruitment and referrals	careers@abc-pvt.example, Ext. 4130
Benefits and insurance	benefits@abc-pvt.example, Ext. 4140
Learning	academy@abc-pvt.example, Ext. 4150
POSH (ICC)	icc@abc-pvt.example
Ethics helpline	ethics@abc-pvt.example, 1800-000-0001

End of document. ABC Private Limited is fictional; all contact details are placeholders created for demonstration and RAG testing.